



“Shocking” iPhone!

A lady from Australia was hospitalised after getting shocked by her iPhone. Pikachu, huh!? <http://dgit.in/13HV5pP>



Lumia 1020 image samples

If you want to check out images shot from the Lumia 1020, how they look, then head over to our online gallery now: <http://dgit.in/1axGmDo>

Feature

Mechanical shutter: Another first

The Nokia Lumia 1020 does away with software based shutter-speeds and introduces a physical shutter into the camera assembly. We're not sure how Nokia managed to do that, since we always feared a delicate shutter system could take damage when the phone is man-handled. So why does a physical shutter matter? Well, for one, you can now have your exposure go between 4 seconds and 1/16000th of a second (Yup. 1-sixteen-thousandth of a second, that's not a typo) for great low light shots or for shots that require stopping motion dead in its tracks.

Xenon flash: Big flash, small size

Another innovation in the Lumia 1020 is the Xenon Flash. This type of flash is extremely powerful, enough to light an 8-member group shot in practically no light, but also for stopping motion. Xenon flashes use a very high capacity capacitor to hold charge, which means any devices using a Xenon Flash will be bulky. Nokia circumvented this problem by developing flat, high capacity capacitors, that take up very little space, but hold all the charge your flash would need. Xenon flashes use this large amount of power to yield a LARGE difference between their t.O1 and t.O5 times, (t.O1 time is when the flash intensity is at 50% of original and t.O5 is 90% of its original power), meaning that the duration of the flash is much longer when compared to a conventional LED flash.

The software: Nokia Pro Camera

We've heard that when it comes to tweaking and playing around with the primary camera interface, Microsoft isn't too willing

of a partner. That makes sense as their philosophy is that the main Windows Phone 8 experience should be uniform across devices, and if they let one manufacturer tweak a core part of the OS, they're going to have to let everyone else do that too, and before you know it, WP8 has turned into Android, and not in a good way. The large sensor on the PureView 808, coupled up with the other technologies, just could not play well with the stock camera interface of WP7 (or WP8 at the time) and reaching a compromise, while developing the software-hardware bridge between the two companies' technologies took a lot of time.

The way has been worth it though, as the Nokia Pro Camera app is definitely going to make you drool, regardless of your qualifications as a photographer. The app puts every kind of control you may need right at your fingertips, in a very easy to use user interface. The app offers the ability to set exposure compensation, shutter speeds, custom white balance, ISO and even manually set focus for all your images. By default, the app sets all values to default, but changing them seems to be a breeze.

The app also has a unique dual-capture mode, where it captures one full resolution image (41/38 megapixels) and one 5 megapixel image (oversampled). This serves a few purposes. Firstly, you can take the full resolution image and zoom into it at a later time to get a better frame. The lower resolution file is the one generated in case you want to share something on Facebook and Twitter instantly.

Closing thoughts

The Lumia 1020 is most definitely a very exciting phone. When we originally played with the PureView 808, we couldn't help but fantasize about that camera making its way to a Windows Phone device from the



Low-light images aren't a problem with Xenon flash

company, and today, that fantasy has come true. However, there is something we are a little concerned about. The Lumia 1020 may have a mind-boggling camera, but the actual hardware on the phone isn't that spectacular. It has a dual-core 1.5 GHz Krait processor with the Adreno 225 GPU. That's the same processor and GPU in the Lumia 920, and we're not saying it's low-end, but what we had hoped for was a beefier spec sheet for a phone that has such an impressive (and processing hungry) camera. The Lumia 1020 does come with an increased amount of RAM (2GB), but what we feel a little apprehensive about is the 32GB of on-board storage with no possibility to increase it using a memory card. The 41 megapixel images are bound to be gargantuan in size, so it would have been nice to have a slot for increasing storage space.

The Lumia 1020 has, as of now, only received a release date for the AT&T network in the US, where it will hit shelves on July 26th for the “low” price of \$299.99 on a two-year contract. When the Lumia 920 was launched on the network, it had a \$100 price tag (on contract), but following that, AT&T offered a \$50 rebate and Nokia too offered a \$50 rebate, making the phone effectively free. We hope that a similar approach would be taken again.

The phone will not be releasing in India this quarter, meaning it could be anytime between the next quarter and eternity that Nokia India brings the phone to our sub-continent.

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